

ENGLISH LANGUAGE NOTES

TOPIC: SYNONYMS AND ANTONYMS

Class: SS1

Subject: English Language

INTRODUCTION

In English Language, words can be related in different ways. Some words have similar meanings, while others have opposite meanings. These relationships are known as synonyms and antonyms. Understanding them helps students improve vocabulary, comprehension, and writing skills.

SYNONYMS

Definition

Synonyms are words that have the same or nearly the same meaning as another word.

Note: Synonyms may not always mean exactly the same thing in every situation, but they are close in meaning.

Examples of Synonyms

Word	Synonym(s)
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Happy:	glad, joyful
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Big:	large, huge
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Small:	little, tiny
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Fast:	quick, rapid
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Begin:	start, commence
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End:	finish, stop
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Angry:	annoyed, furious
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Brave:	bold, courageous
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Easy:	simple
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Clever:	intelligent, smart
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Synonyms Used in Sentences

1. The children were happy (glad) to see their teacher.
2. Nigeria is a big (large) country.
3. The exam was very easy (simple).
4. He is a clever (intelligent) boy.

Uses of Synonyms

To avoid repeating the same word

To make essays and speeches more interesting

To improve vocabulary

To express ideas more clearly

ANTONYMS

Definition

Antonyms are words that have opposite meanings.

Examples of Antonyms

Word	Antonym
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Hot	cold
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Tall	short
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Old	young
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Happy	sad
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Rich	poor
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Early	late
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Open	closed
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Clean	dirty
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Strong	weak
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Light	heavy
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Antonyms Used in Sentences

1. The soup is hot, not cold.
2. My elder brother is tall, but I am short.
3. The classroom is clean, not dirty.
4. She arrived early, not late.

Uses of Antonyms

To show contrast in meaning

To explain ideas clearly

To improve comprehension in reading passages

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN SYNONYMS AND ANTONYMS

Synonyms	Antonyms
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Have similar meanings	Have opposite meanings
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Example: big – large	Example: big – small
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Used to avoid repetition	Used to show contrast.
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SUMMARY

Synonyms are words with similar meanings.

Antonyms are words with opposite meanings.

Both help improve vocabulary and writing skills.

CLASSWORK / EXERCISE

A. Give one synonym for each word:

1. Fast
2. Angry
3. Begin

4. Small

5. Happy

B. Give one antonym for each word:

1. Early

2. Clean

3. Strong

4. Rich

5. Hot